made it clear that her or his ideas were personal and of a tentative nature.

One of the moves in the Chinese playbook is to play the victim. They are good at this. The narrative starts with the 'century of humiliation' during which China was ravaged by rapacious outside powers for no fault of China's. This assertion is intended to engender a vague feeling of sympathy. Then the Chinese negotiator might go on to recount how the Americans and the Soviets took their turns at bullying the Chinese during the Cold War. This diatribe usually concludes with the Chinese interlocutor suggesting that China's legitimate desire to 'rise' in the world is now being 'contained' by the Americans, and to hint at unnamed countries which are joining the Americans in this exercise. The allusion is to India. Although India suffered a much worse fate under the imperial rule of outside powers than China, the Chinese will still use the victimhood complex with India. They will also claim that India has taken over the mantle of imperialism and hegemonism from Great Britain in South Asia. Such a narrative allows the Chinese to claim that India is victimizing China after 1947. In the face of Chinese assertions that 'you are the guilty party', Indian interlocutors, out of politeness, rarely push back. This might put the Indian side on the defensive. An occasional show of aggression, which the Chinese do not expect from Indians, helps to counter this tactic.

If and when the Chinese feel that they have hit the bottom line, and if they think the agreement meets with their own requirements, they are likely to seal the bargain. There is more than one way to do so. They may let a negotiation appear to deadlock to test the interlocutor's patience and firmness, and then have a senior leader intervene at the last moment to 'cut the knot' of disagreement. [10] A classic instance of this was during the working level talks in Beijing in February 1999 to resolve the impasse in bilateral relations after India's nuclear